

Steve Stone Joins Glamorous List

SAN FRANCISCO (AP) — Rookie pitcher Steve Stone has joined an illustrious list of Jewish ballplayers who've been members of the Giants.

When the team was in New York, having a Jewish star was considered a big box office asset because of New York's large Jewish population. In San Francisco, Stone's strong right arm is his biggest asset.

"I haven't seen a kid come up with so much natural talent since Juan Marichal in 1961," says Giants' Manager Charlie Fox.

Sid Gordon, an outfielder, was the last Jewish star with the Giants. He played his final year in New York in 1949—when Steven Michael Stone was a 2-year-old toddler in the Cleveland suburb of South Euclid, Ohio.

"I don't remember Gordon or any of those other guys," admits the 23-year-old Stone, who is proud of his faith, but says he's only mildly aware of the past Jewish Giants such as Gordon, Andy Cohen, Harry Danning, Harry Feldman and Phil Weintraub.

"A guy my age can only identify with somebody like Sandy Koufax. Of course, there's only one Sandy Koufax," Stone says in praise of the Los Angeles Dodgers' former pitching star who also is Jewish.

"Mom would always say that I'd become another Koufax, but it was a little embarrassing, he recalls."

"That's quite a bit to live up to. I'm just very happy to be starting in the major leagues so soon."

Fox named Stone to his starting pitching rotation midway in

spring training, although the former Kent State University athlete wasn't on the team's 40-man roster.

He broke into organized baseball just two years ago, with a 12-13 record for Fresno of the Class A California League. Last year, he had a combined record of 14-8 at Amarillo of the Texas League and Phoenix of the Pacific Coast League.

"Steve has a great future," says Fox. "What I like about the kid is his confidence. He's not afraid to throw any pitch in any situation."